

Business Formation & Startup Checklist

Organize the decisions, records, and operating foundations involved in starting a business. You do not need every answer before contacting Alchemize.

01 / ESTABLISH THE BUSINESS

Clarify the business identity, ownership, and formation information.

01 BUSINESS IDENTITY

- ☐ Proposed legal business name
- ☐ Alternate or DBA names being considered
- ☐ Primary business activity
- ☐ Short business purpose description
- ☐ State where the business will be formed
- ☐ Primary operating location
- ☐ Planned launch date

04 FEDERAL / TAX IDENTITY

- ☐ EIN status
- ☐ Responsible-party information
- ☐ Tax-classification questions for an appropriate tax professional
- ☐ Prior federal business registrations, if applicable

02 OWNERSHIP & MANAGEMENT

- ☐ Owner or member names
- ☐ Ownership percentages, where applicable
- ☐ Management structure
- ☐ Responsible party
- ☐ Authorized decision-makers

03 FORMATION PREPARATION

- ☐ Entity type being considered
- ☐ Registered agent information
- ☐ State filing information
- ☐ Formation document status
- ☐ Ownership or organizational agreements to discuss with qualified counsel

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02 / PREPARE TO OPERATE

Build the practical infrastructure that supports the launch.

01 BUSINESS CONTACT INFRASTRUCTURE

- ☐ Business email
- ☐ Domain
- ☐ Business phone, where applicable
- ☐ Business address strategy
- ☐ Website or online presence

02 FINANCIAL FOUNDATION

- ☐ Business bank account
- ☐ Recordkeeping or bookkeeping approach
- ☐ Expense tracking
- ☐ Initial owner-funding records
- ☐ Payment-processing needs, where applicable

03 OPERATIONAL FOUNDATION

- ☐ File storage
- ☐ Contracts or templates needing qualified review
- ☐ Recurring administrative calendar
- ☐ Licenses or permits to investigate
- ☐ Insurance considerations
- ☐ Document-retention approach

04 DIGITAL FOUNDATION

- ☐ Domain and email ownership
- ☐ Digital-account inventory
- ☐ Password and access-management plan
- ☐ Backups

05 BEFORE LAUNCH

- ☐ Formation filing complete
- ☐ EIN obtained where required
- ☐ Business banking prepared
- ☐ Recordkeeping system selected
- ☐ Required licenses or permits researched
- ☐ Insurance needs reviewed
- ☐ Core business records organized

QUESTIONS / DECISIONS TO DISCUSS

SECURITY NOTE Do not send Social Security numbers, banking information, tax returns, identification documents, medical information, or other sensitive records through an unsecured form or ordinary email. Use an approved method when instructed.

This checklist provides general organizational guidance and is not legal advice. Formation, tax, licensing, and other requirements vary by business and jurisdiction.